

mountain state of Nepal. Earlier, a 2.5 ft narrow-gauge line existed here, built during the British rule to transport timber from Nepal, which stopped running in 2014. Construction for the line has begun and train services are expected to start soon. A 39-km-long line from Raxaul, Bihar in India, to Birgunj, a city in Nepal also existed – built in 1924–27, but mostly to move freight, and it stopped service in 1965. Since then, the tracks on the Indian side have been converted to broad gauge.

There have been several other feasibility studies as well, looking at ideal train connections between countries. Notable among these was a proposal to link parts of Bhutan with Assam and West Bengal. However, there has been no movement on this plan.



▲ **Maitree Express** ready for departure from the cantonment station in Dhaka in April 2008 amid cheers from the crowd.